

Nykenge (Nikki) is 21 years old, she is completing her second semester at UMass Boston. Prior to attending UMass Boston, Nikki took a class at Bunker Hill Community College.

How long have you attended UMass Boston and why are you here?

Two semesters. It's a really big deal for me. I've met a lot of people. It is a bigger campus [than Bunker Hill]. There is a lot of people and more navigating to do on campus.

What classes have you taken at UMass Boston?

Food and empire- I liked this class. It was about food and drinking, it was more history. I had to keep a food diary once a week. I did the exams last semester, wrote a paper too. Communication course- this one is good too but it's really nice, I learned about grammar and language.

You have an internship as a hostess in the dining hall? Do you like it?

It's really nice. I met Kathy (coworker). She's been helpful and she's kind. She helps me greet people.

What do you like to do at UMass Boston?

Hangout with my friends, talk to Bella, my peer mentor, meet fellow students. I like the bacon, ham and cheese sandwiches!

What are some of the hardest parts of college?

The bus is hard. I am still working on traveling, can't do it by myself yet. It is hard making new friends. At Bunker Hill I had a lot of friends. Darryl [a friend] came here and introduced UMass Boston to me and he was really helpful to me, he was kind. Darryl left and that was hard.

What do you like best about college?

Hanging out with mentors.

What advice might you give to a younger student who is nervous about trying college?

It'll be okay if you meet new people.



Nikki on campus



**It'll be okay if you
meet new people.**

–Nykenge Blue

[Sign up](#) to receive our monthly newsletter for more interviews, events and activities, and Think College publications.

If you or someone you know would like to be interviewed, contact sheila.johnson@umb.edu for more information.



Nikki and her classmates at UMass Boston



Massachusetts Inclusive Concurrent Enrollment Initiative (MAICEI) program at the University of Massachusetts Boston

The UMass Boston MAICEI program offers inclusive higher education opportunities to partnering local school districts that support high school students with intellectual disabilities and autism, ages 18-21. Students can increase their academic, social, and career outcomes by sharing the same experiences as their college peers and enrolling in undergraduate courses as non-degree-seeking students.

Learn more about MAICEI

[Visit the program website](#)

[Read an article in the campus newspaper](#)



ThinkCollege.net Resources for Students

[College Search](#)

This page has information on 300+ college programs for students with ID.

[Handouts in Plain and Clear Language](#)

These publications are written so they are easy to read and understand.

[Student Corner](#)

This webpage has articles and videos created just for students.

[Student Interviews and Stories](#)

These stories are about students' experiences before, during, and after college.



FOLLOW

www.thinkcollege.net



www.facebook.com/thinkcollege



www.twitter.com/thinkcollegeICI



CONTACT

thinkcollegeTA@gmail.com



SUBSCRIBE

www.thinkcollege.net/subscribe-to-mailing-list

This is a publication of the Think College National Coordinating Center, a project of the Institute for Community Inclusion at the University of Massachusetts Boston, funded by the Office of Postsecondary Education (Grant No. P407B15002). The opinions contained in this document are those of the grantee and do not necessarily reflect those of the funders.



ThinkCollege

NATIONAL COORDINATING CENTER

INSTITUTE FOR COMMUNITY INCLUSION, UMASS BOSTON